# Link

**USER MANUAL**

Wireless remote for your hi-fi



## A wireless remote for your hi-fi.

Phone, tablet and computer.

Firmware 2.3.80 · October 2026

**NOTE**

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# 01

# What Link does

Link connects to your preamplifier's RS-232 control port and puts it on your home network. Any phone, tablet or computer in the house is then a remote.

```
Phone · Tablet · PC  ──Wi-Fi──▶  Link  ──RS-232──▶  Preamplifier
```

- Volume, mute, inputs, tone, outputs.
- Always in sync: turn the knob on the preamplifier and every screen follows.
- A volume limit, enforced in Link.
- No account, no cloud. Link fetches only its own updates.
- Also: subwoofers, room correction, a disc player, a music streamer's transport controls.

02

# What you need

- A preamplifier with an **RS-232 control port**: a 3.5 mm jack on current models, a DB9 on a few older ones (see Compatible equipment).
- A 2.4 GHz **Wi-Fi network**.
- The free **Link app** (App Store / Google Play) for setup.
- A **USB-C charger**, 5 V, 0.5 A or more.

**In the box:** Link, one control cable (3.5 mm to 3.5 mm, or 3.5 mm to DB9, as chosen at order) and one USB-C cable. A further 3.5 mm device needs an ordinary stereo (TRS) cable. A DB9 cable is wired tip to pin 2, ring to pin 3, sleeve to pin 5.

# 03

# Connect it



*Rear panel*

Left to right: the **control ports**, the **USB-C** power socket, the **status light**, the **button**.

1. **Control cable** from any PORT on Link to the RS-232 jack on the preamplifier. Any port; Link finds out what is plugged in where.
2. **More devices.** A second preamplifier, a B&W DB1 subwoofer, a MEN220 room-correction processor or a McIntosh MVP disc player: one cable each, into any free port.
3. **Power.** Plug in USB-C last. Link has no power switch and is meant to stay on.

**NOTE**

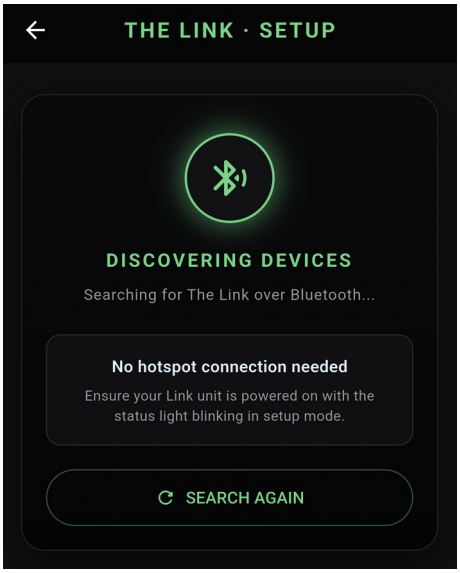
Leave the preamplifier's RS-232 baud rate at its factory setting (115200). Link finds other rates too, but slower.

# 04

# First-time setup

A new Link blinks **blue, twice, pause**. It is waiting to be set up.

## With the Link app

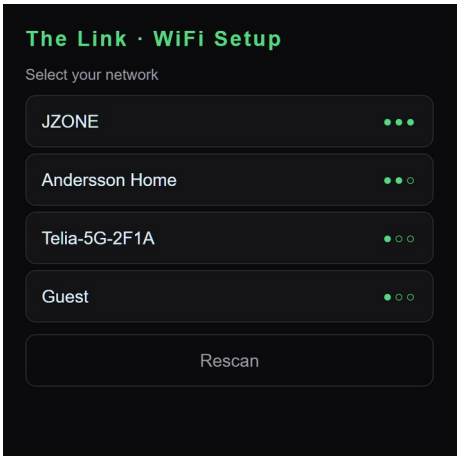



1. Install **Link** from the App Store or Google Play and open it. Allow Bluetooth; it is used only for setup.
2. The app searches over Bluetooth. Stay within a few metres of the unit.
3. It shows the Wi-Fi networks the unit can see. Pick yours and type the password. Optionally name the unit; the name becomes its address (`Studio` → `http://studio.local`).
4. Tap **Connect**. The light goes solid green and the app opens the remote.

A wrong password is reported after about a minute.

## Without the app

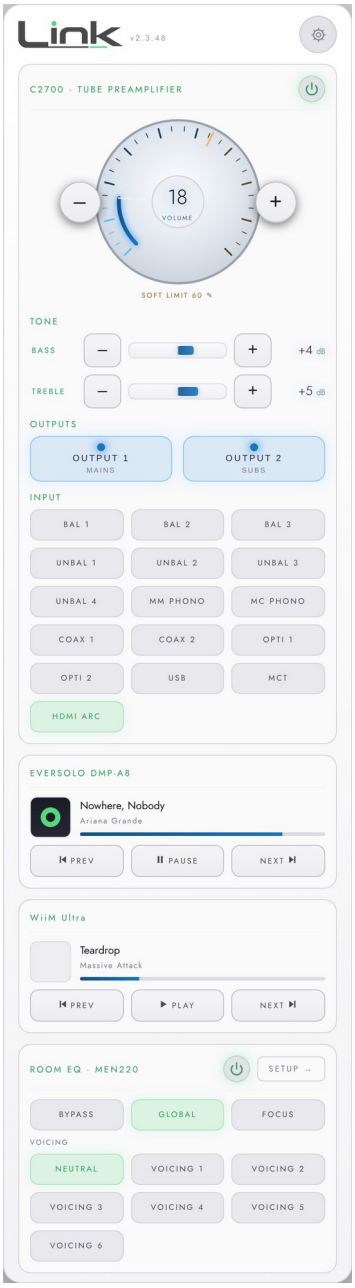
If the app says **"Can't find it?"**, or Bluetooth is unavailable:




1. Join the Wi-Fi network **`Link`**, password **`linksetup`**. Accept any "no internet" warning.
2. A setup page opens. If not, go to **`http://192.168.4.1`**.
3. Pick your network, type its password, optionally name the unit, tap **Connect**.
4. Return your device to your home Wi-Fi.

# 05

# The remote




Open the **Link app**. It finds your Link and shows the remote.

On a computer, or without the app, open **`http://link.local`** in a browser (`http://<name>.local` if you named the unit). It is the same remote, served by Link. Chrome or Edge → address-bar menu → **Install** keeps it one click away.

Every phone, tablet and computer in the house can be open at once. They all show the same thing; Link holds the state.

## The main screen

One screen. Each piece of equipment has its own card.

## The preamplifier card

**Power** — the ⏻ button in the card header. Tube preamplifiers take about 15 seconds to warm up.

**Volume** — the dial. Tap **+** and **–**; hold to run. On a computer, the scroll wheel over the dial or the arrow keys. **Tap the number in the middle to mute.** There is no drag and no tap-on-dial: volume moves one step at a time.

**Soft limit** — the line under the dial. See Volume safety.

**Tone** — bass and treble, ±12 dB. Tap **TONE** to switch the tone controls in and out. The preamplifier stores tone per input. Models without tone controls hide the section.

**Surround** — A/V receivers and processors only (AUTO / THROUGH / MOVIE / MUSIC / GAME).

**Outputs** — OUTPUT 1 and OUTPUT 2. Rename them in Panel Setup.

**Inputs** — a button per input. Hide and rename them in Panel Setup.

## The streamer cards

Link finds Eversolo, WiiM, BluOS (Bluesound, NAD, DALI, PSB), Denon and Marantz HEOS, OpenHome (Linn, Lumin, Auralic), Cambridge Audio and other UPnP/DLNA players on your network. Each gets a card: cover art, title, artist, a progress bar you can tap to seek, **PREV · PLAY · NEXT**.

What a card can do depends on the player and its current source: a HEOS speaker has no progress bar, internet radio may not allow skipping back, generic UPnP/DLNA players may show little track information.

**SHOW ON PANEL** on a streamer's page hides that card. **REMOVE** drops the player. Televisions are never listed.

Link does not control the streamer's volume. The preamplifier owns volume.

### The disc player card

Shown when a McIntosh **MVP861**, **MVP871** or **MVP901** is connected to a port: state, track, **PREV · STOP · PLAY/PAUSE · NEXT**, power.

### The room-correction card

Shown when a McIntosh MEN220 is connected. See section 8.

### Several preamplifiers

Up to four preamp-class devices at once, by port or over the network. With two or more, tabs appear at the top. Each has its own volume, limit, names and safety.

### Themes

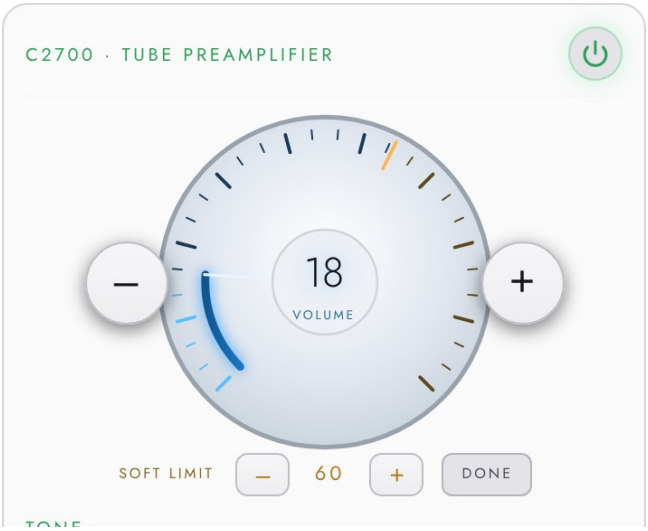
DARK, LIGHT, GRAPHITE, SILVER, CLASSIC and STUDIO, under **Panel Setup → SYSTEM → THEME**. Per phone or browser. This manual uses LIGHT.

# 06

# Volume safety

**Link never sends an absolute volume.** Only "one step up" or "one step down", each confirmed by the preamplifier before the next. No glitch, stale screen or lost connection can produce a jump.

**The soft limit** is a ceiling. Under the dial: `SOFT LIMIT 60` ✎. Tap it, adjust with **–** / **+**, tap **DONE**. Volume-up is dropped at the ceiling. It is enforced in Link, so it holds for every phone.




*Editing the soft limit*

**To go above the limit,** reach it; **UNLOCK >60** appears under the dial. Tap it. After 30 seconds the ceiling is back.

**Lowering the limit below the current volume** steps the volume down to meet it.

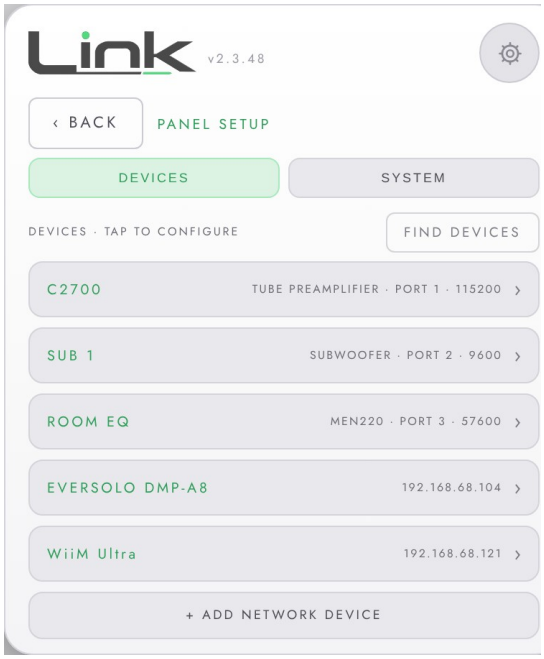
Always on: a minimum interval between steps; hold-to-repeat is the app sending single steps, so a lost connection stops the volume at once; the screen shows only what the preamplifier has confirmed.

> **NOTE**
> Set the limit before you need it.

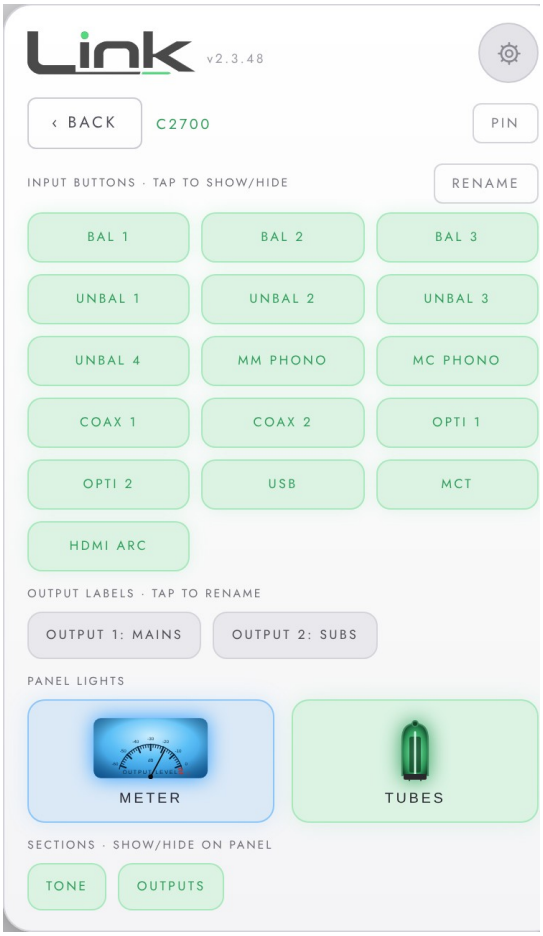
# 07

# Panel Setup

☰ top right, then **SETTINGS**. Two tabs: **DEVICES** and **SYSTEM**. The menu also has FIND DEVICES, THEME, CHECK FOR UPDATE, REARRANGE CARDS and ABOUT.




*Panel Setup — devices*




*A preamplifier's own settings page*

## DEVICES

What Link has found, with port and speed. Tap a row for that device's settings. Ports still searching are listed dimmed as "PORT n — scanning...".

**FIND DEVICES** looks again: empty ports, streamers, supported preamplifiers on the network. It never removes a wired device; one that has stopped answering stays listed as lost.

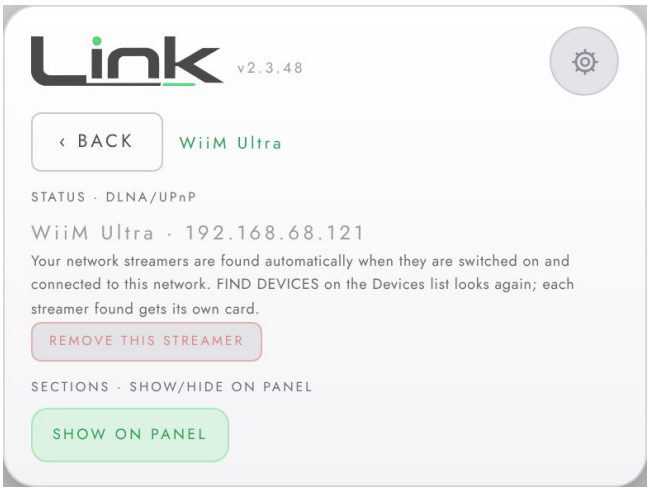
**A preamplifier's page:**

- **INPUT BUTTONS** — tap to show or hide; **RENAME** to relabel.
- **OUTPUT LABELS** — tap to rename.
- **PANEL LIGHTS** — METER and TUBES, where the model has them.

- **PREAMP SETTINGS** — the preamplifier's own trim menu: balance, input trim, mono, display brightness, headphone HXD, phono loads (while a phono input is selected), and on models that have them phono gain, processor loop, output 1 trim and dual mono. Output 1 mode and crossover are shown for reference; set them on the preamplifier. Only what the model reports is listed. Stored in the preamplifier, per input; the heading names the input.
- **SECTIONS** — show or hide TONE and OUTPUTS on the main screen.

The layout is stored in Link, per model, so every phone sees the same and a device keeps its names and limit when moved to another port.

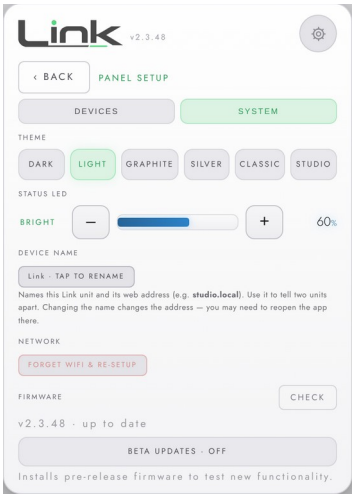
**A streamer's page:** name and address; **SHOW ON PANEL**; **OPEN WITH**, the app its card opens (on Android, any app on the phone; on iPhone, a list of music apps; stored per phone); **REMOVE THIS STREAMER**.




*A streamer's settings page*

**+ ADD NETWORK DEVICE** — see section 9.

## SYSTEM




- **THEME**
- **STATUS LED** — brightness of the light on the box.
- **DEVICE NAME** — names the unit and sets its address. Use it to tell two units apart.
- **NETWORK** — **FORGET WIFI & RE-SETUP**.
- **FIRMWARE** — the running version; **CHECK** for updates. See section 11.
- **BETA UPDATES** — pre-release versions. Off by default.

### Pinning a setting to the main screen

Any setting on a device page can be placed in a **PINNED** card on the main screen.

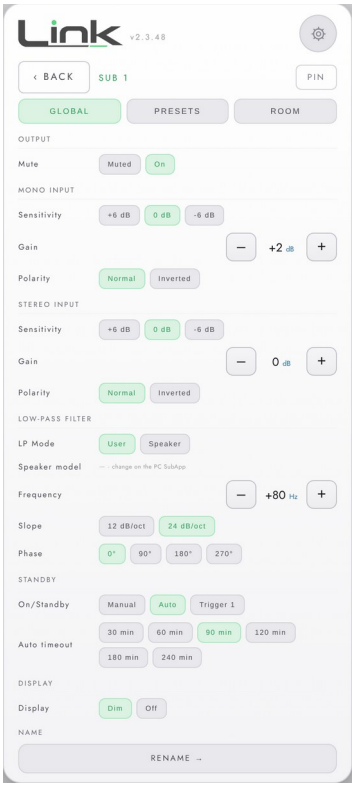
1. Open the device's page and tap **PIN** in its header.
2. Tap the setting. While PIN is on, a tap pins instead of changing.
3. Tap **PIN** again.

Press and hold a setting to pin or unpin it directly. Pins are stored in Link.

# 08

# Subwoofers and room correction

**Subwoofers.** Two **B&W DB1** subwoofers, one cable each into any free port. They appear in **Panel Setup → DEVICES** with the settings of the manufacturer's own app: gain, sensitivity, polarity, low-pass filter, standby, presets, mute, rename.




Room measurement stays on a PC; it needs the manufacturer's microphone.

**Room correction.** A McIntosh **MEN220** appears as a **ROOM EQ** card:




*Room EQ card*

- **Correction mode** — Bypass, Global, or a Focus position.
- **Voicing** — Neutral plus six.
- Power, focus position and rename on its **SETUP** page.

Focus positions are measured with the processor's own setup. Link selects between them.

# 09

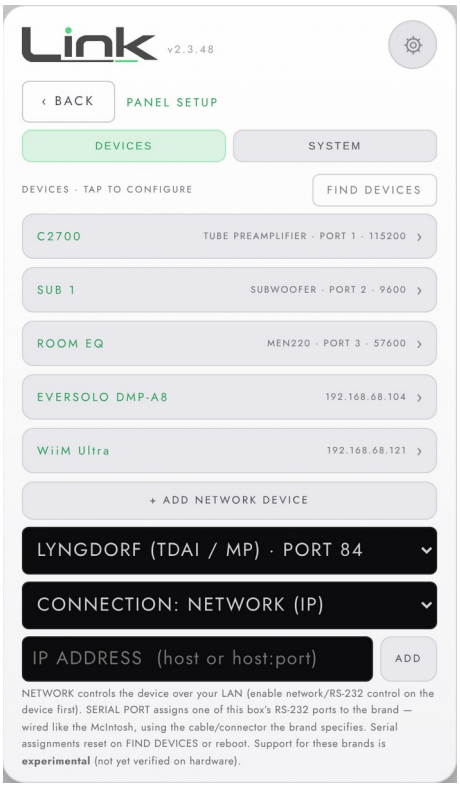
# Adding other brands

Preamplifiers, integrated amplifiers and processors from **Lyngdorf, Rotel/Michi, Denon/Marantz, NAD, Yamaha, Onkyo/Integra, Audio Research, Arcam, Anthem, Mark Levinson, Primare, Meridian, Trinnov/JBL Synthesis, Krell** and **Classé**, over the network or wired to a port.

Link looks for them by itself: after start-up, when the remote is idle, and on **FIND DEVICES**. A receiver that is also a network player (Denon, Marantz, Yamaha, Onkyo, Integra, Arcam, Lyngdorf) is added as a preamplifier beside its streamer card. A removed network device is not added again by itself.

**Panel Setup → DEVICES → + ADD NETWORK DEVICE** is for a device the search does not reach, for example one that ignores ping or sits on another network:

1. Pick the brand.
2. Pick the connection: NETWORK, or one of Link's ports.
3. For a network device, type its IP address (`:port` only if changed from the brand default). Tap **ADD**.

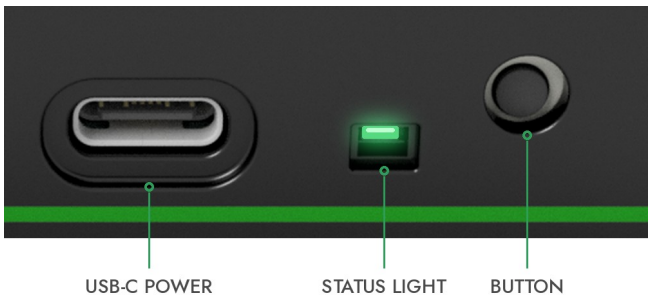



Notes:

- Enable network control ("IP control", "network standby") on the device, or it stops answering when it sleeps.
- Volume is relative-only and limit-protected on every brand, as in section 6. The dial uses the brand's own scale.
- Port assignments reset on reboot; network devices are remembered.
- These brands are **experimental**: written from the manufacturers' control documentation, not yet verified on a real unit. Try at low volume first.

# 10

# The button and the light




*Button and status light*

## The button

| PRESS | DOES |
|---|---|
| **Short press** | **Sleep.** Light out, radio off. Press again to wake. |
| **Hold 5 seconds** | **Factory reset.** The light flashes red; at 5 s it goes dark. Let go. |

**NOTE**
Asleep, Link is off the network and the app cannot wake it. Only the button can.

A factory reset erases everything in Link (Wi-Fi, names, limits, layout) and reopens setup mode. It does not touch the preamplifier's own settings. Releasing before five seconds is a sleep press, not a reset.

## The status light

| RHYTHM | COLOUR | MEANING |
|---|---|---|
| **Solid** | green | On the network, talking to the equipment |
| **Slow breathe** | amber | On the network, equipment not answering. Check the cable. |
| **Fast breathe** | amber | Cannot join the saved Wi-Fi |
| **Two quick blinks, pause** | blue | Setup mode |
| **Fast flashing** | red | Button held. Let go to cancel. |
| **Off** | — | Asleep, or no power |

# 11

# Updates

Link checks about once a day and installs new versions while the remote is idle. If one is waiting when you open the app, the FIRMWARE line in **Panel Setup → SYSTEM** shows **UPDATE**; tap to install now.

- Updates are signed and verified in Link before installing.
- An update takes about 20 seconds. The music keeps playing; the volume cannot be changed from the phone meanwhile. The page reloads itself.
- A version that misbehaves is rolled back by Link.
- **BETA UPDATES** (Panel Setup → SYSTEM) also receives pre-release versions. Switching it off keeps the current version until the next regular release overtakes it.
- The app may show *"A new version of the app is available — RELOAD"*. Tap RELOAD.

Updates are the only thing Link fetches from the internet.

# 12

# Troubleshooting

**The app says NO LINK NEARBY.** Blue blinking: setup mode, follow section 4. Solid green: already on a network; tap **ENTER AN ADDRESS** and type `link.local`. Dark: asleep; press the button. Amber breathing: cannot reach its saved network; hold the button until the light goes dark and set it up again.

**`link.local` doesn't open.** Some Android and older Windows versions cannot resolve `.local` names. Find `link` (or your name for it) in the router's device list and use its IP address. A named unit is at the name in lowercase, spaces as hyphens: `Living Room` → `http://living-room.local`.

**The app opens but is not connected to the equipment.** Check the control cable at both ends and that the preamplifier is on. Then **Panel Setup → DEVICES → FIND DEVICES**.

**Volume won't go higher.** The soft limit. Tap **UNLOCK** under the dial, or raise the limit.

**An input reports an error when selected.** It is switched Off in the preamplifier's setup menu. Enable it there, or hide it in Panel Setup.

**A streamer or network receiver isn't found.** Switch it on, on the same network as Link, then **FIND DEVICES**. Guest networks and separate segments block the search; a supported receiver can be added by hand with **+ ADD NETWORK DEVICE**.

**Two units clash.** Every unit answers to `link.local` until it is named. Name one in **Panel Setup → SYSTEM → DEVICE NAME**. It moves to its own address and leaves `link.local` to the other.

**Starting over. Panel Setup → SYSTEM → FORGET WIFI & RE-SETUP**, or hold the button until the light goes dark.

# 13

# Compatible equipment

Link works with equipment that has an RS-232 control port with a selectable baud rate. It detects the model by itself and adapts the screen to it.

| | |
|---|---|
| **McIntosh preamplifiers** | C2500, C2600, C2700, C2800, C47, C48, C49, C50, C52, C53, C55, C1100, C12000 |
| **McIntosh integrated amplifiers** | MA5300, MA352, MA7200, MA8900, MA8950, MA9000, MA9500, MA12000 |
| **McIntosh processors / receivers** | MHT300, MX100, MX200 |
| **McIntosh digital preamplifier** | D1100 |
| **McIntosh disc players** | MVP861, MVP871, MVP901 (transport and power) |
| **DB9 port** (choose the DB9 cable when ordering) | C48, C50, C2500, MEN220, MVP861, MVP871, MVP901, B&W DB1. All others have the 3.5 mm jack. |
| **Other brands** (experimental) | Lyngdorf, Rotel/Michi, Denon/Marantz, NAD, Yamaha, Onkyo/Integra, Audio Research, Arcam, Anthem, Mark Levinson, Primare, Meridian, Trinnov/JBL Synthesis, Krell, Classé |

**Also:** B&W DB1 subwoofers · McIntosh MEN220 room correction · Eversolo, WiiM and BluOS streamers (full) · Denon and Marantz HEOS, OpenHome (Linn, Lumin, Auralic) and Cambridge Audio players (now playing and transport) · other UPnP/DLNA players (transport).

**Not supported:** equipment with only a Data Port, an IR input or trigger outputs, such as the McIntosh C2200, C2300, MA7000 and the MVP831, MVP841 and MVP851. These are one-way connections. Link does not use infrared.

A receiver or processor with a **volume scale** setting: leave it on the linear 0–99 scale.

# 14

# Care, power and specifications

| | |
|---|---|
| Ports | 3 × 3.5 mm TRS, RS-232 |
| Network | Wi-Fi 2.4 GHz, Bluetooth LE (setup only) |
| Power | USB-C, 5 V, 0.5 A minimum (cable included, charger not) |
| Cooling | Passive, silent |
| Enclosure | Compact desktop box |

No user-serviceable parts. Keep it in open air, not in a sealed cabinet or on a warm component. Wipe with a dry cloth.

## Support

**info@playandtrack.com**

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